

QuadConnect

A Verified Campus Social Discovery Platform

Wireframes & Design Rationale

QuadConnect is a verified student-only platform that helps UIUC students discover compatible peers and build meaningful connections through structured, in-person experiences.

Team Name: The Connectors

Team Number: Team 13

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Listed alphabetically by surname. All team members are considered equal contributors.

AI / Tool Usage Disclosure

This submission uses digital design and AI-assisted documentation tools. The tools were used to develop and communicate the prototype and its design rationale; the project concept and all interaction decisions are those of the student team.

Tool / Model	Version	Use in this submission
Figma Sites	Version not specified	High-fidelity interactive prototype (Appendix, v2)
ChatGPT	GPT-5.6 Luna	Project documentation, screen descriptions, design-rationale wording
Claude	Opus 5	Low-fidelity wireframe generation (pages 3-11) and document assembly
PyMuPDF	1.25.5	Programmatic rendering of the low-fidelity wireframes

Prototype

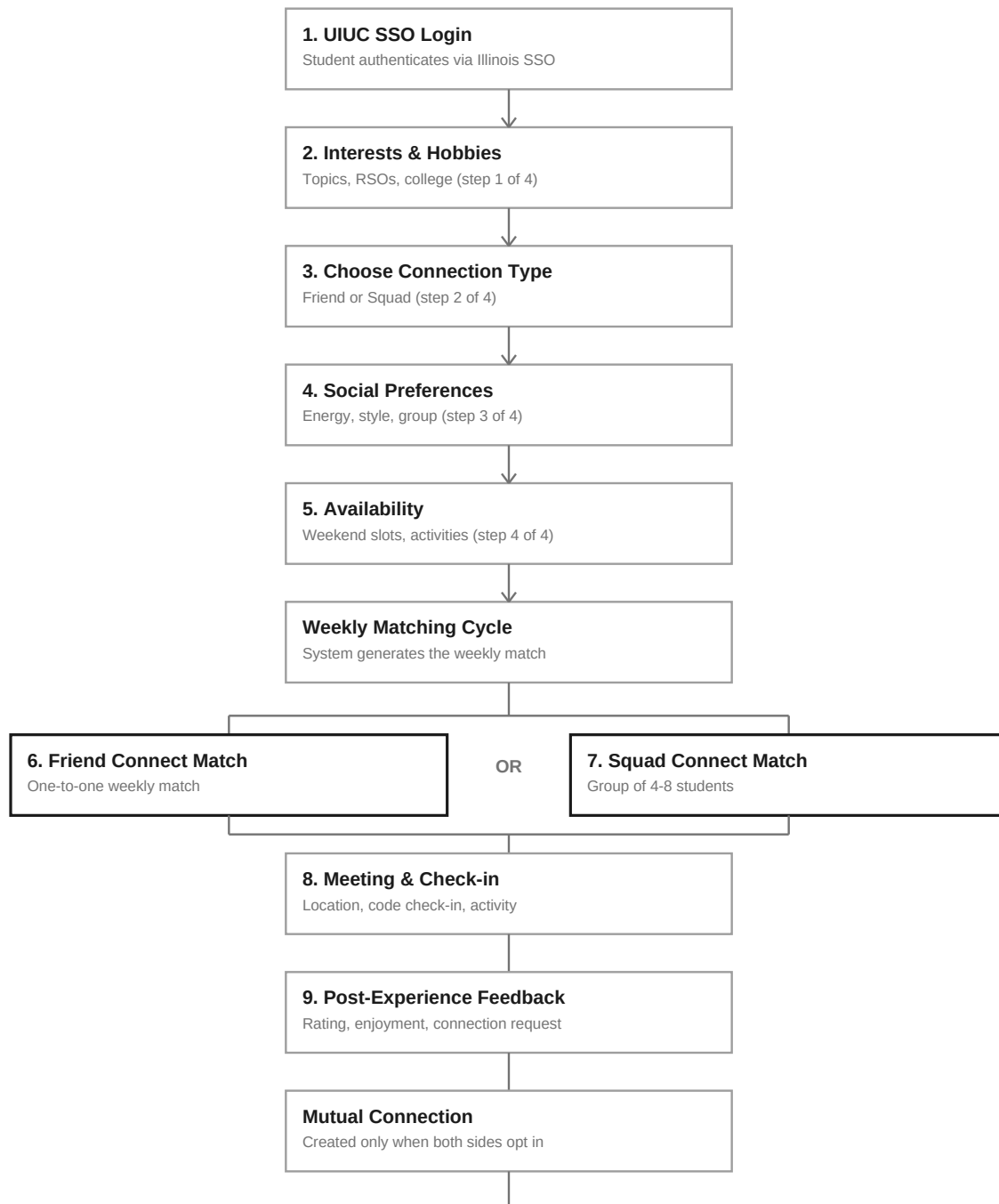
<https://trek-galaxy-20520998.figma.site/>

Submission Note

Pages 3-11 present the low-fidelity wireframes required by the assignment: one screen per page, each with its page purpose, key UI elements, and intended user interactions. The high-fidelity Figma prototype screenshots are retained in the appendix as design iteration v2.

Screen Flow

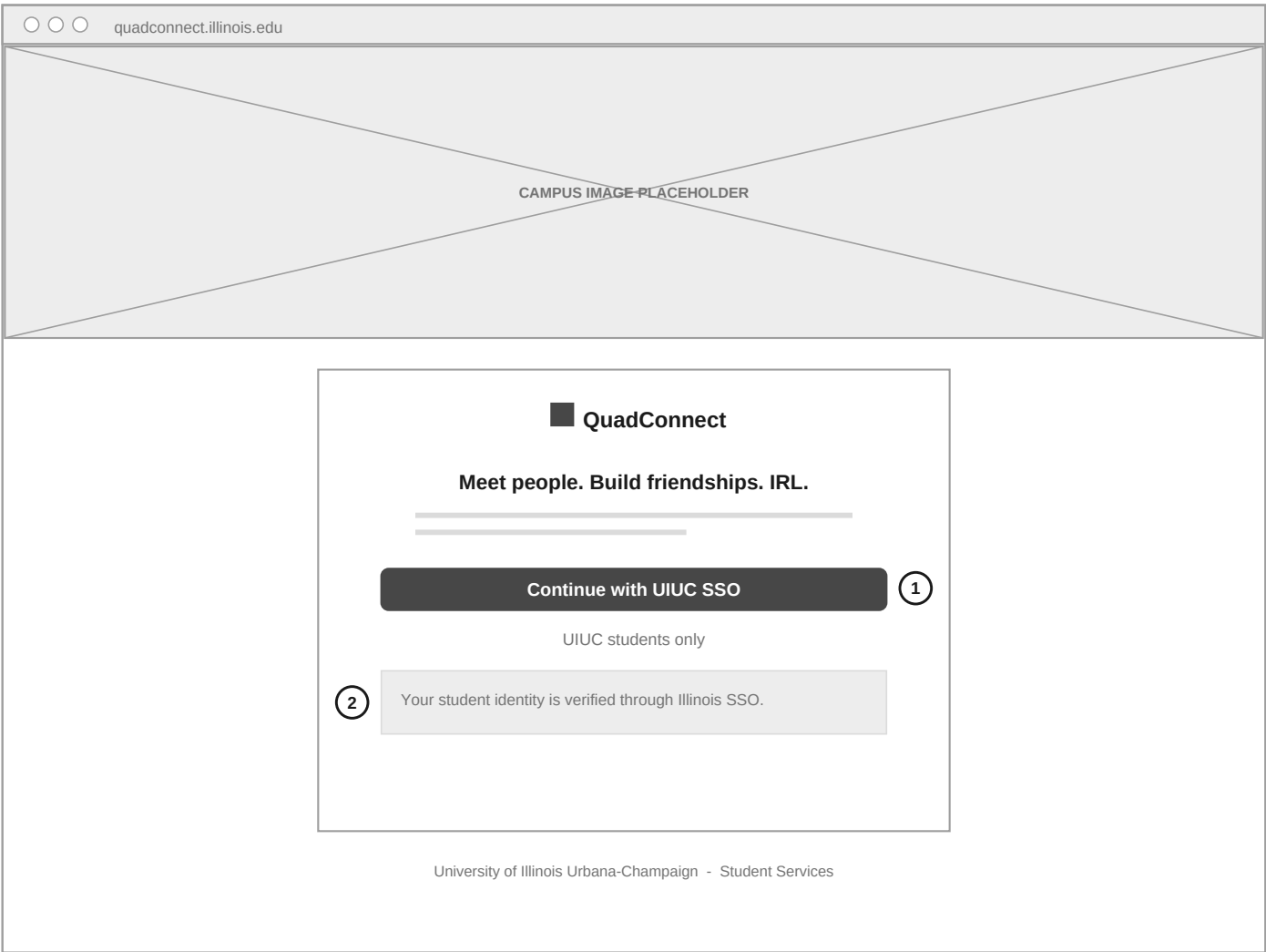
Primary user journey from authentication to mutual connection, showing the point at which the flow branches into the one-to-one or small-group matching path.



KEY DESIGN PRINCIPLES

- Weekly matches, not continuous browsing
- UIUC SSO verification - students only
- Mutual opt-in for any post-meeting connection
- In-person experience at approved campus locations
- Limited personal info before the meeting
- Private feedback improves future matches

UIUC SSO Login



INTENDED USER INTERACTIONS

- ① Single primary action: selecting Continue with UIUC SSO hands off to the Illinois Shibboleth identity provider.

② On a successful return the student is routed to Screen 2; a failed or non-student login returns here with an error.
- ③ No email/password fields and no sign-up path exist - verification is the only way in.

PAGE PURPOSE

Provides verified access to the student-only QuadConnect community through university authentication.

Interests & Hobbies

quadconnect.illinois.edu

1 Interests — 2 Connection — 3 Social Prefs — 4 Availability

What are you into?

HOBBIES & INTERESTS

Select all that apply - these drive your match.

Sports
Gaming
Music
Movies
Food
Fitness
Art
Travel
Reading
Technology
Outdoors
Photography
Other

3 selected

RSOS YOU'RE CONNECTED TO ON CAMPUS

Illinois Student Government
Engineers Without Borders
UIUC Dance Marathon
Business Illini
Illini Media
UIUC Esports
Other RSO

Don't see yours? Add it:

PART-TIME WORK (OPTIONAL)

☐ I don't currently have a job

YOUR COLLEGE / DEPARTMENT

v

Back
Continue

INTENDED USER INTERACTIONS

- Interest and RSO chips are multi-select toggles: tapping one selects or clears it, and a live count confirms the selection.
- Free-text field lets a student add an RSO missing from the catalogue rather than abandoning the step.
- Continue is disabled until at least one interest is chosen, so an unmatched empty profile cannot be created.
- Part-time work and major are explicitly optional and labelled so, reducing the perceived cost of the step.
- Back returns to the previous stage with all selections preserved.
- The stepper shows stage 1 of 4, keeping the remaining effort visible.

PAGE PURPOSE

Collects hobbies, interests, campus involvement, academic background, and optional work information used to support compatible matching.

Choose Connection Type

quadconnect.illinois.edu

1 Interests — 2 **Connection** — 3 Social Prefs — 4 Availability

Welcome to QuadConnect

HOW DO YOU WANT TO CONNECT?

1

Friend Connect

Meet one UIUC student one-on-one.

1-on-1 - Weekly match - In-person

2

Squad Connect

Meet a small group of 4-8 UIUC students.

4-8 students - Weekly group - In-person

Continue 2

Select a connection type to continue.

[Back to interests](#)

INTENDED USER INTERACTIONS

- Exactly two options are offered as large selectable cards; the whole card is the hit target, not just the radio control.
- Selecting a card outlines it and enables Continue, which stays disabled with an explanatory line until a choice is made.
- Choosing a type determines which match screen the student later sees - Screen 6 for Friend, Screen 7 for Squad.
- The choice is revisitable later from Profile, so it is not a one-way door.

PAGE PURPOSE

Lets students choose between one-to-one Friend Connect and small-group Squad Connect experiences.

Social Preferences

quadconnect.illinois.edu

1 Interests
2 Connection
3 Social Prefs
4 Availability

What kind of social experience do you prefer?

SOCIAL ENERGY

1

Quiet

Balanced

Very social

CONVERSATION STYLE

☒ Casual conversations
☐ Deep conversations
☐ Activity-focused

PREFERRED ENVIRONMENT

☒ Coffee / Cafe
☐ Outdoors
☐ Food
☐ Games
☒ Campus spaces

GROUP PREFERENCE

2

☐ One person
☒ Small group (3-5)
☐ Either

AGE PREFERENCE

3

☒ Same age (+/-1 yr)
☒ Slightly older/younger
☐ Any age
☐ Prefer older students

RSO & COMMUNITY PREFERENCE

☒ Prefer shared RSO overlap
☐ Open to any RSO background
☐ Not important

Back
Continue

INTENDED USER INTERACTIONS

- Social energy is a continuous slider rather than named buckets, so the value can be compared numerically when matching.
- The page scrolls; the scroll indicator and the persistent stepper keep the student oriented in a long form.
- Single-choice groups use radios and multi-choice groups use checkboxes, so the control shape signals how many answers are allowed.
- Degree-level and cross-department preferences continue below the fold in the same card pattern.
- Every group ships with a sensible default selected, so the step can be completed by scrolling past it.
- Continue advances to Screen 5; Back preserves all answers.

PAGE PURPOSE

Collects social energy, conversation style, preferred environments, group size, and other preferences that influence matching.

Availability & Meeting Preferences

quadconnect.illinois.edu

1

Interests

2

Connection

3

Social Prefs

4

Availability

When can you meet?

Select times when you're generally available on weekends.

SATURDAY

10 AM-12 PM

12-2 PM

2-4 PM

4-6 PM

SUNDAY

10 AM-12 PM

12-2 PM

2-4 PM

4-6 PM

PREFERRED MEETING ACTIVITIES

☒ Coffee

☒ Campus walk

☐ Food

☐ Board games

☐ Sports

☐ Study/social space

MEETING PREFERENCE

☐ Public campus location

☒ Indoor

☐ Outdoor

All meetings take place at approved public campus locations.

Back

Complete Profile

INTENDED USER INTERACTIONS

- 1

Time windows are discrete toggle tiles, not a free-text time entry, so availability is directly comparable between students.
- 2

Complete Profile is the terminal action of onboarding and enrolls the student in the next weekly matching cycle.
- 3

Multiple slots per day may be selected; at least one is required before the button enables.
- 4

The location note sets the safety expectation before any match is produced.

PAGE PURPOSE

Collects available time windows, preferred activities, and meeting-environment preferences so matches can be scheduled realistically.

Weekly Friend Connect Match

quadconnect.illinois.edu

QuadConnect Home My Connection Profile JA

FRIEND CONNECT - WEEK OF SEP 7

Your Weekly Connection

Alex

UIUC Student - Verified

Additional profile details visible after match acceptance.

WHY YOU MATCHED

- Basketball
- Gaming
- Coffee
- Saturday availability

SUGGESTED EXPERIENCE

Coffee + Campus Walk

- Saturday
- 2:00 PM
- Approved campus location

Your match is based on shared interests, preferences, and availability. Matches reset weekly.

Accept Match **Decline**

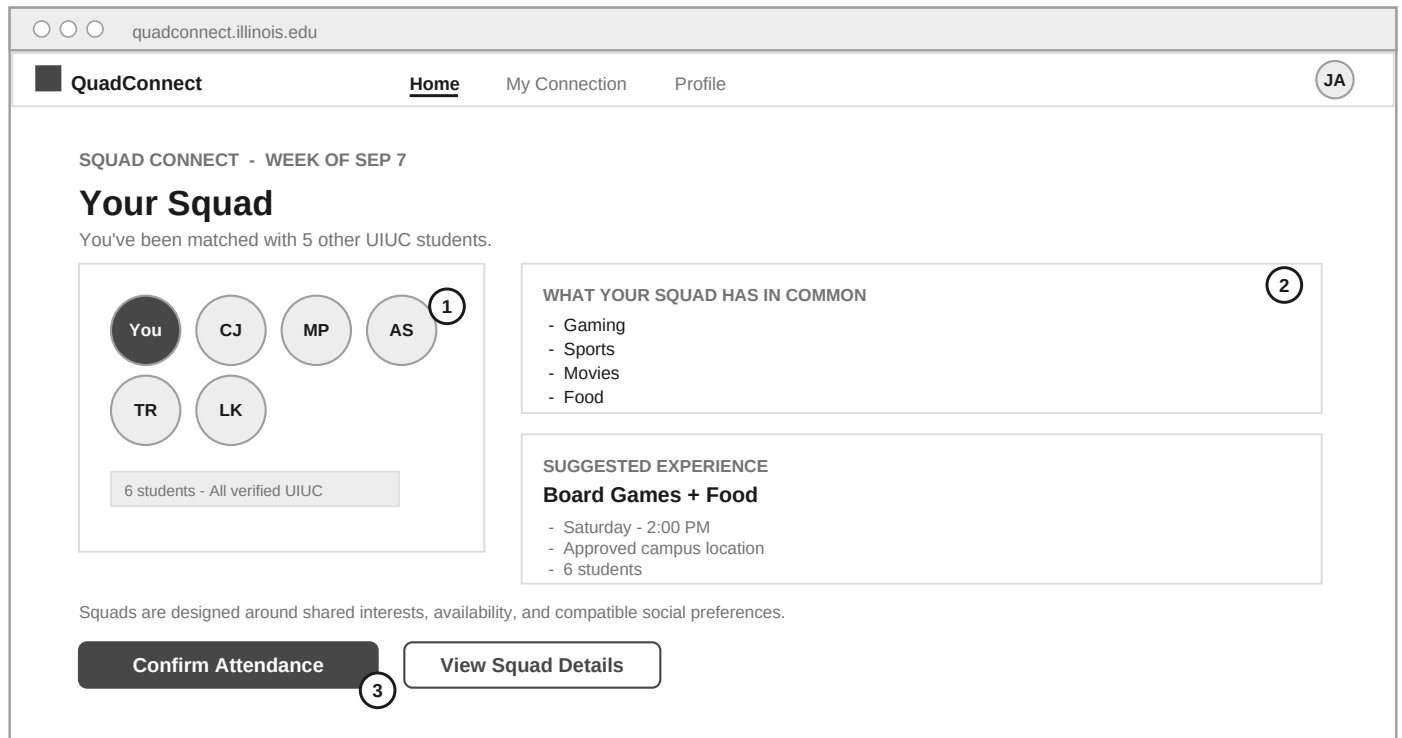
INTENDED USER INTERACTIONS

- ① The match is explained, not just presented: the shared factors that produced it are listed so the pairing is legible.
- ② Identifying detail is withheld until both sides accept, limiting what is disclosed before mutual consent.
- ③ Accept Match advances to Screen 8; Decline releases the match and returns the student to the pool for the next cycle.
- ④ Exactly one match is shown per week - there is no feed and no browsing, which is the core product decision.
- ⑤ The week label makes the cadence explicit.

PAGE PURPOSE

Presents a student's weekly one-to-one match, explains shared compatibility factors, and provides a suggested activity and meeting details.

Squad Connect Match



INTENDED USER INTERACTIONS

- ① Squad members appear as initialled avatars only; no names or photos are exposed before the meeting.
- ② Commonality is shown at group level rather than per person, which is what makes a group of six legible at a glance.
- ③ Confirm Attendance commits the student to the meeting and unlocks Screen 8; View Squad Details expands the roster.
- ④ The verified-students badge restates that everyone present passed SSO verification.
- ⑤ Group size is capped at 4-8 so the meeting stays conversational.

PAGE PURPOSE

Presents a small group of compatible UIUC students, highlights shared interests, and provides the group's suggested experience.

Meeting & Check-in

The screenshot shows a web browser window with the URL 'quadconnect.illinois.edu'. The navigation bar includes 'QuadConnect', 'Home', 'My Connection' (active), and 'Profile'. A user icon 'JA' is in the top right.

Today's Connection

Saturday - 2:00 PM Approved UIUC campus location

MAP PLACEHOLDER

Map placeholder - approved campus location marked

Illini Union - 1401 W Green St

Main entrance, ground floor lobby

BEFORE YOU ARRIVE

- 1 Arrive at the designated location.
- 2 Check in using your QuadConnect code.
- 3 Meet your connection.
- 4 Follow the suggested activity.

CHECK IN

QC - 4827

Check In

1

3 in the designated public campus location. QuadConnect only facilitates meetings in approved university spaces.

INTENDED USER INTERACTIONS

- 1 A short alphanumeric code plus QR gives two ways to check in, so a dead camera or dead battery does not block attendance.
- 2 The map and arrival note remove ambiguity about where exactly to stand on arrival.
- 3 The safety banner is persistent, not dismissible, restating the approved-location rule at the moment it matters.
- 4 Check In records attendance and unlocks Screen 9 after the meeting window closes.
- 5 Numbered arrival steps sequence the unfamiliar part of the experience.

PAGE PURPOSE

Provides the approved campus meeting location, arrival instructions, and a check-in mechanism before the experience begins.

Post-Experience Feedback

quadconnect.illinois.edu

Home
My Connection
Profile

JA

How was your experience?

OVERALL RATING

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

WHAT DID YOU ENJOY?

☒ Conversation
☒ Shared interests
☐ Activity
☐ Meeting new people
☐ Comfortable environment

WOULD YOU LIKE TO STAY CONNECTED?

Select squad members you'd like to stay connected with.

☒ CJ	Squad member - CJ	☒
☒ MP	Squad member - MP	☒
☐ AS	Squad member - AS	☐
☐ TR	Squad member - TR	☐
☐ LK	Squad member - LK	☐

Submit Feedback

☒ feedback is private and helps improve future matches. Connections are only created when interest is mutual.

INTENDED USER INTERACTIONS

- A single star rating is the only required input; everything else is optional, keeping the post-meeting cost near zero.
- Stay-connected is a per-person opt-in, so a student can value one member of a squad without opting into all of them.
- The privacy note states plainly that feedback is never shown to the other participants and that connections need mutual consent.
- Submit Feedback closes the cycle and feeds the stored rating back into the next round of matching.
- Feedback is requested only after a check-in is recorded, so ratings correspond to meetings that actually happened.

PAGE PURPOSE

Collects private experience feedback and lets students indicate which participants they would like to stay connected with.

Design Choices & Rationale

The prototype is intentionally structured as a simple, sequential flow. The design prioritises clarity, low cognitive load, predictable navigation, and trust, because students are being asked to share personal preferences and eventually meet a stranger in person.

1. Simplicity & Cognitive Load

Onboarding is divided into four focused screens instead of presenting every question at once. Interests, connection type, social preferences, and availability are separated into meaningful stages. This limits the amount of information a student must hold in working memory at any moment, following Cognitive Load Theory, and it means a student who abandons the flow loses one stage rather than everything.

2. Hick's Law

The connection screen presents two clear choices rather than a large menu. Decision time grows with the number of options, so the prototype deliberately ships Friend Connect and Squad Connect only, leaving further connection types to later iterations once the two core formats are validated.

3. Fitts's Law

Primary actions - Continue, Complete Profile, Accept Match, Confirm Attendance, Check In, and Submit Feedback - are large, visually distinct, and placed in predictable positions. On the connection screen the entire card is the target rather than just its radio control, which reduces the pointing effort for the most important decision in the flow.

4. Consistency & Affordance

The screens reuse one card-based section pattern, one heading hierarchy, and one control vocabulary throughout. Single-choice groups always use radio buttons and multi-choice groups always use checkboxes, so the shape of a control tells the student how many answers are allowed before they read the label. Primary buttons are filled; secondary actions are outlined.

Design Choices & Rationale (continued)

5. Visibility of System Status

The onboarding stepper, weekly match labels, meeting date and time, location details, and check-in state all tell the student where they are and what happens next. Disabled primary buttons are always accompanied by a line of text explaining what is still required, rather than leaving the student to guess.

6. Trust, Privacy & Safety

SSO verification establishes a student-only environment. Meetings occur only at approved public campus locations, restated in a persistent banner on the meeting screen. Identifying details are withheld until a match is accepted, feedback is private, and a lasting connection requires mutual opt-in. Safety is expressed as product structure, not as a policy page.

7. Matching Rationale & Explainability

The prototype does not rely on shared hobbies alone. It collects availability, social energy, conversation style, environment preference, age and degree-level preferences, campus communities, and activities. Crucially, the match screen shows why a pairing happened; an unexplained match is hard to trust and hard to act on.

8. Visual Hierarchy

Large page titles identify the task, section labels divide related information, and primary actions carry the strongest visual weight. Cards group related fields into scannable regions so a long preference form can be skimmed without collapsing it behind additional navigation.

Justification of Layout & Flow

The flow is linear because each stage supplies data the next stage depends on: connection type determines which match screen applies, and availability is a hard constraint on scheduling. Branching occurs once, at the match step, and the two branches reconverge at check-in and feedback so there is a single path to a completed experience. Navigation after onboarding collapses to three destinations - Home, My Connection, and Profile - because a student has exactly one active experience at a time.

Iteration & Versioning

The design was developed in two passes. Both are included so the progression, and the reasoning behind it, is visible rather than implied.

v1	Low-fidelity wireframes (pages 3-11 of this document) Greyscale line art with placeholder content. Fidelity is kept deliberately low so that review attention lands on structure, information order, control choice, and flow rather than on typography or colour. Each screen is annotated with its purpose and its intended interactions.
v2	High-fidelity interactive prototype (appendix) Built in Figma Sites and published as a clickable prototype. This pass added real UIUC context, the campus photograph on the login screen, brand colour on primary actions, and working navigation between all nine screens, so the flow could be walked end to end.

What Changed Between Passes

- Social preferences were split out of the interests screen once the combined step proved too long to complete in one pass.
- The connection-type choice moved ahead of social preferences, so later questions can be framed around the format already chosen.
- The match screen gained an explicit "why you matched" panel; without it the pairing read as arbitrary.
- A second check-in method (short code alongside the QR) was added so a phone problem cannot block attendance.
- Stay-connected changed from one blanket choice to a per-person opt-in after review of the squad case.

Open Questions for the Next Iteration

- Is four onboarding stages still too long? Completion rate per stage would answer this.
- Do students prefer one-to-one or group experiences, and does that preference change after a first meeting?
- Does the match explanation change acceptance rate?
- Accessibility: contrast, focus order, and screen-reader labelling have not yet been audited.

Appendix

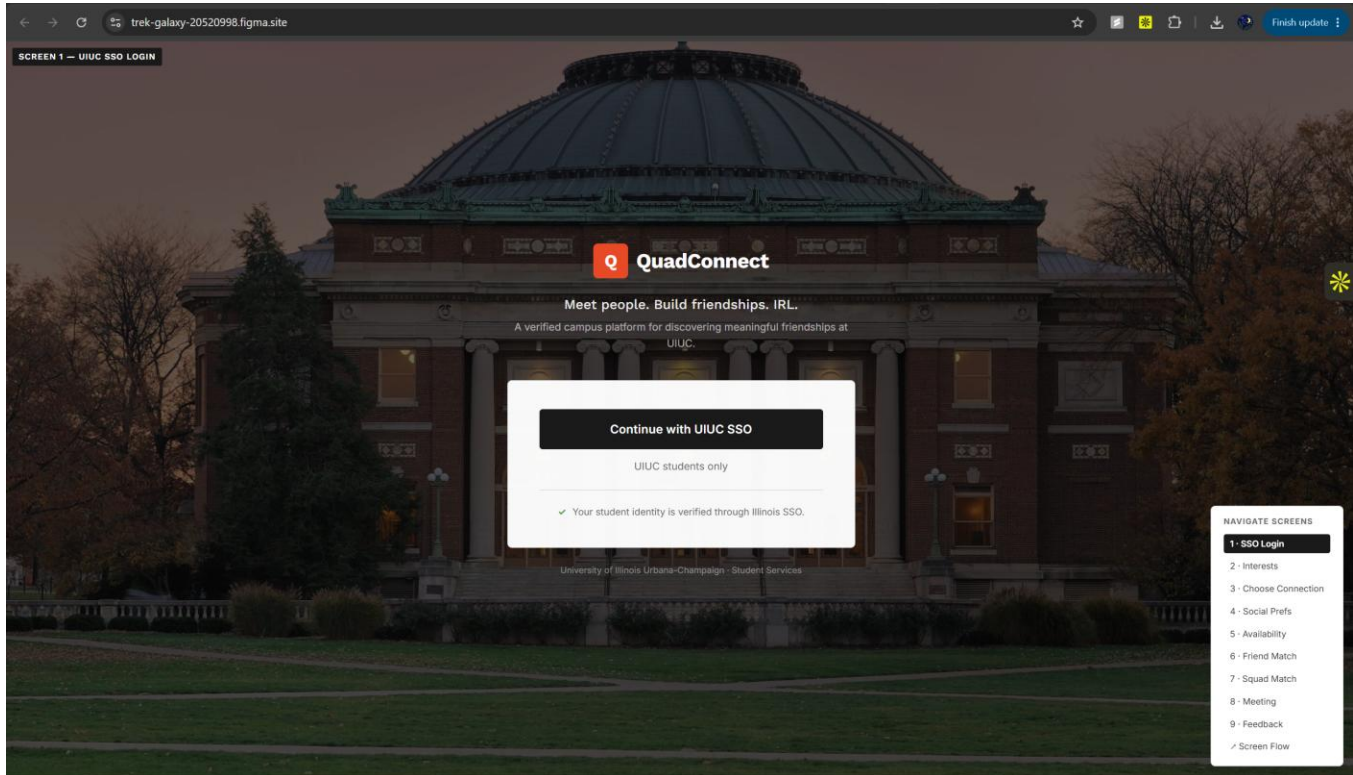
Iteration v2 - High-Fidelity Prototype Screenshots

The following pages are screenshots of the high-fidelity Figma Sites prototype. They are included as design-iteration evidence and are not the low-fidelity wireframe deliverable, which appears on pages 3-11.

Prototype: <https://trek-galaxy-20520998.figma.site/>

Screen 1 — UIUC SSO Login

Purpose: Provides verified access to the student-only QuadConnect community through university authentication.



Screen 2 — Interests & Hobbies

Purpose: Collects hobbies, interests, campus involvement, academic background, and optional work information used to support compatible matching.

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Q QuadConnect JK

SCREEN 2 — INTERESTS & HOBBIES

1 Interests — 2 Choose Connection — 3 Social Preferences — 4 Availability

What are you into?

Tell us about your interests, campus involvement, and academic background so we can find compatible connections.

HOBBIES & INTERESTS

Select all that apply — these drive your match.

Sports

Gaming

Music

Movies

Food

Fitness

Art

Travel

Reading

Technology

Outdoors

Photography

Other

3 selected

RSOs YOU'RE CONNECTED TO ON CAMPUS

Registered Student Organizations you're a member of. Helps match you with students in similar communities.

Illinois Student Government

Engineers Without Borders

UIUC Dance Marathon

Business Illini

Illini Media

UIUC Esports

Habitat for Humanity UIUC

Indian Students Association

UIUC Pre-Med Society

Illini Robotics

Chinese Students Association

UIUC Entrepreneurship Club

Other RSO

Don't see yours? Add it:

e.g. Illini Cycling Club

PART-TIME WORK (optional)

If you have a part-time job on or near campus, sharing this can help surface students with similar schedules or workplaces.

Campus Dining – Server

☐ I don't currently have a part-time job

YOUR COLLEGE / DEPARTMENT

Helps match you with students across or within your college based on your preference.

Grainger College of Engineering

Specific major or program (optional)

e.g. Computer Science, Finance + Statistics

← Back

Continue →

NAVIGATE SCREENS

1 · SSO Login

2 · Interests

3 · Choose Connection

4 · Social Prefs

5 · Availability

6 · Friend Match

7 · Squad Match

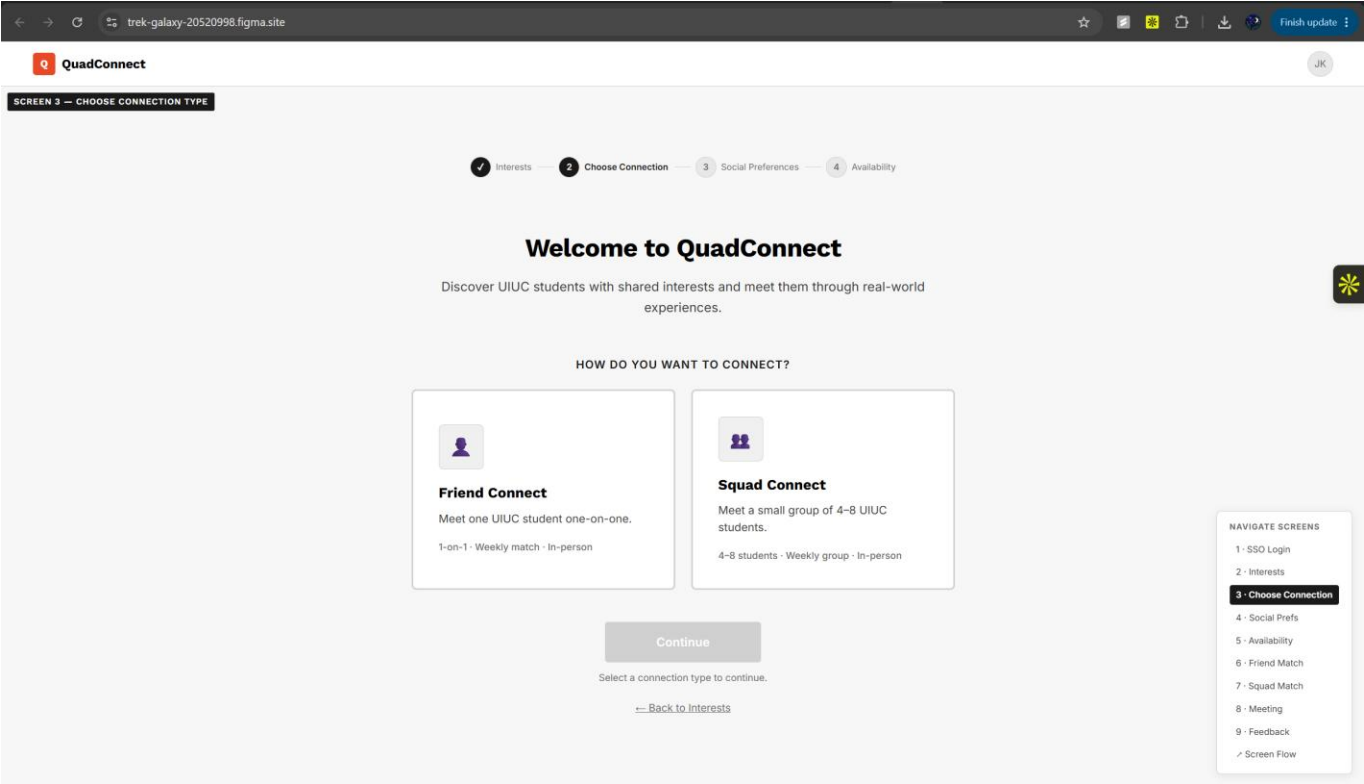
8 · Meeting

9 · Feedback

➤ Screen Flow

Screen 3 — Choose Connection Type

Purpose: Lets students choose between one-to-one Friend Connect and small-group Squad Connect experiences.



Screen 4 — Social Preferences

Purpose: Collects social energy, conversation style, preferred environments, group size, and other preferences that influence matching.

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JK

QQuadConnect

SCREEN 4 — SOCIAL PREFERENCES

✓Interests

✓Choose Connection

3Social Preferences

4Availability

What kind of social experience do you prefer?

Help us find connections that match your social style and background.

SOCIAL ENERGY

Quiet / Low-key

Balanced

Very Social

CONVERSATION STYLE

☒Casual conversations

☐Deep conversations

☐Activity-focused

PREFERRED ENVIRONMENT

☒Coffee / Café

☐Outdoors

☐Food

☐Games

☒Campus spaces

GROUP PREFERENCE

☐One person

☒Small group (3-5)

☐Either

AGE PREFERENCE

Who are you most comfortable connecting with? Select all that apply.

☒Same age (±1 yr)

☒Slightly older/younger (±2 yrs)

☐Any age

☐Prefer older students

☐Prefer younger students

DEGREE LEVEL PREFERENCE

Which student levels are you open to connecting with?

☐Undergrad (Freshman)

☒Undergrad (Junior)

☐Master's student

☐Professional student (Law, Med, etc.)

☐Undergrad (Sophomore)

☒Undergrad (Senior)

☐PhD student

☐Any level

RSO & COMMUNITY PREFERENCE

How important is it to be matched with students in similar campus communities?

☒Prefer shared RSO overlap — same club or org community

☐Open to any RSO background — diversity of involvement preferred

☐Not important — RSO membership doesn't factor into my match

Cross-department matching

☐Same college / department as me

☐Different college / department — I want to meet students outside my field

☒No preference

NAVIGATE SCREENS

1 · SSO Login

2 · Interests

3 · Choose Connection

4 · Social Prefs

5 · Availability

6 · Friend Match

7 · Squad Match

8 · Meeting

9 · Feedback

➤ Screen Flow

NAVIGATE SCREENS

1 · SSO Login

2 · Interests

3 · Choose Connection

4 · Social Prefs

5 · Availability

6 · Friend Match

7 · Squad Match

8 · Meeting

9 · Feedback

➤ Screen Flow

← Back

Continue →

Screen 5 — Availability & Meeting Preferences

Purpose: Collects available time windows, preferred activities, and meeting-environment preferences so matches can be scheduled realistically.

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JK

QQuadConnect

SCREEN 5 — AVAILABILITY & MEETING PREFERENCES

✓Interests

✓Choose Connection

✓Social Preferences

4Availability

When can you meet?

Select times when you're generally available on weekends.

SATURDAY

10 AM-12 PM

12-2 PM

2-4 PM

4-6 PM

SUNDAY

10 AM-12 PM

12-2 PM

2-4 PM

4-6 PM

PREFERRED MEETING ACTIVITIES

☒Coffee

☐Food

☐Sports

☒Campus walk

☐Board games

☐Study/social space

MEETING PREFERENCE

☐Public campus location

☒Indoor

☐Outdoor

NAVIGATE SCREENS

1 · SSO Login

2 · Interests

3 · Choose Connection

4 · Social Prefe

5 · Availability

6 · Friend Match

7 · Squad Match

8 · Meeting

9 · Feedback

➤ Screen Flow

MEETING PREFERENCE

☐Public campus location

☒Indoor

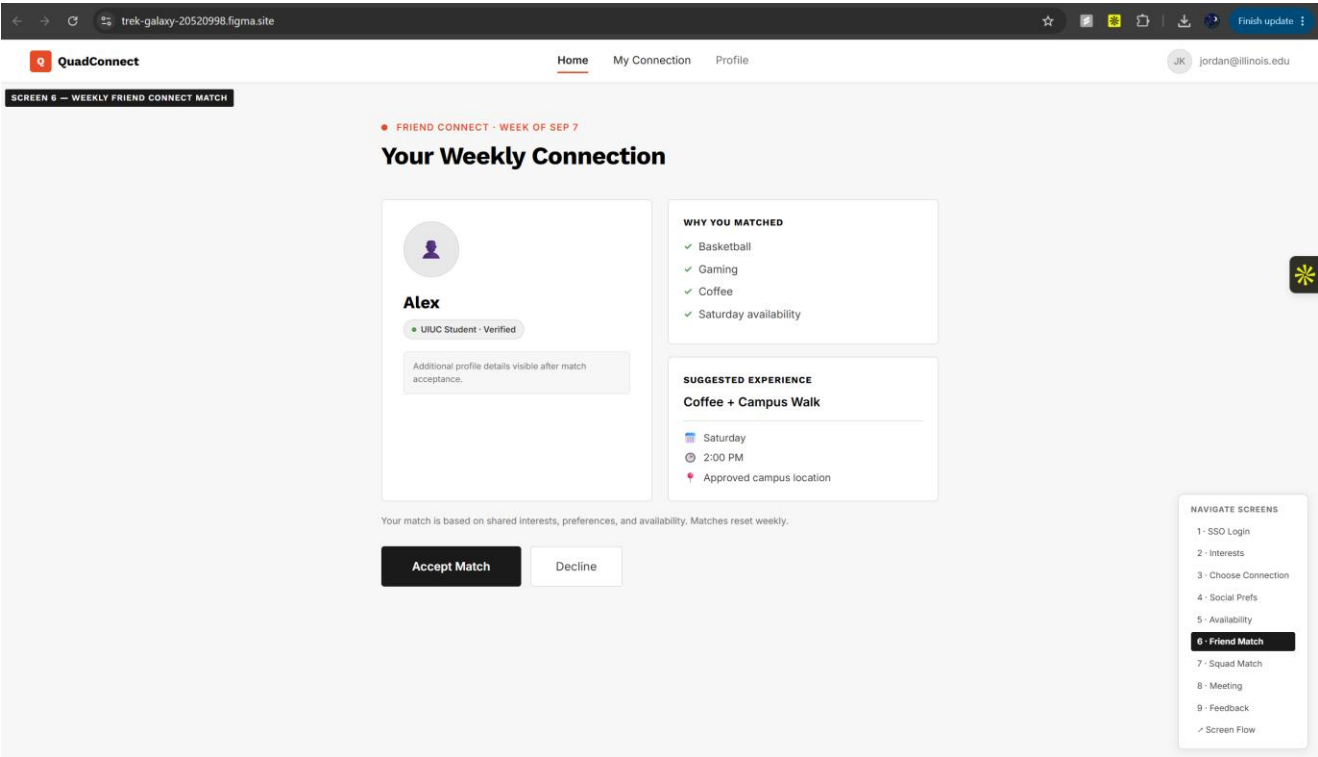
☐Outdoor

← Back

Complete Profile →

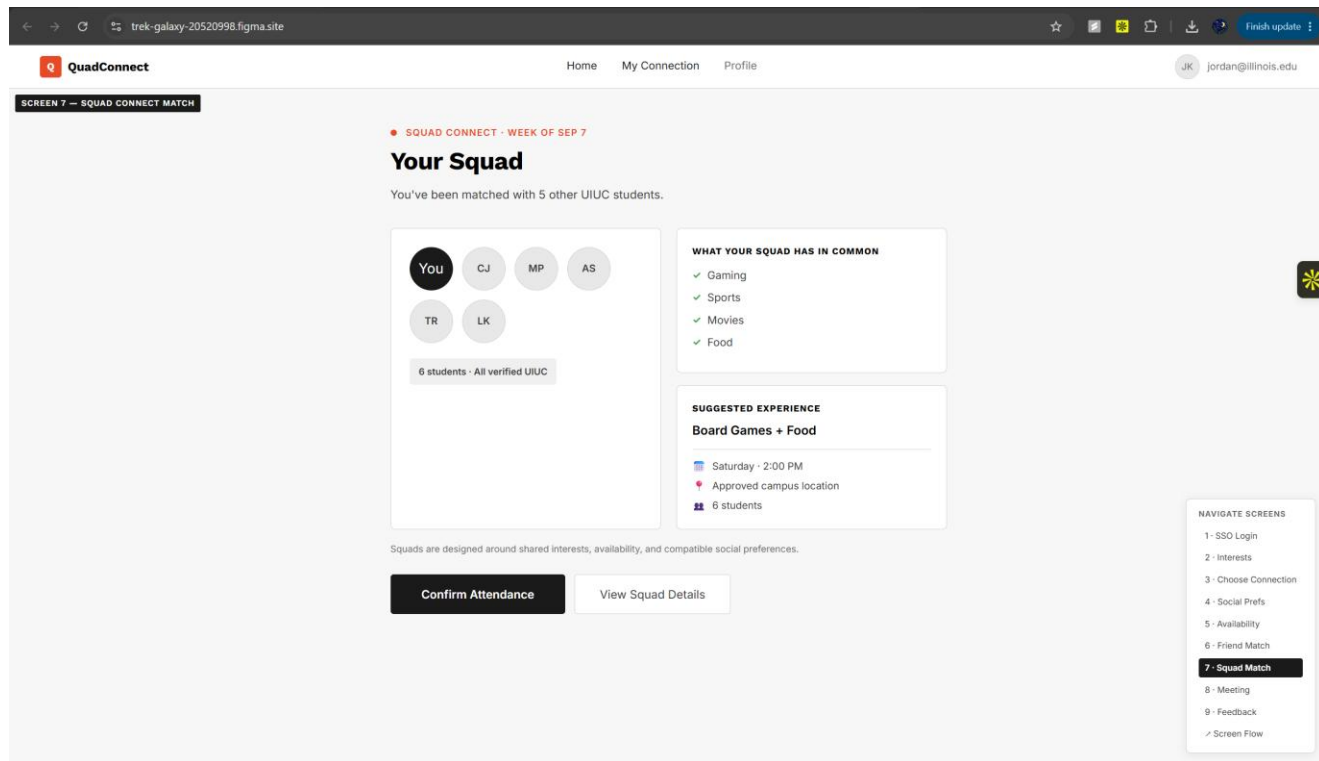
Screen 6 — Weekly Friend Connect Match

Purpose: Presents a student's weekly one-to-one match, explains shared compatibility factors, and provides a suggested activity and meeting details.



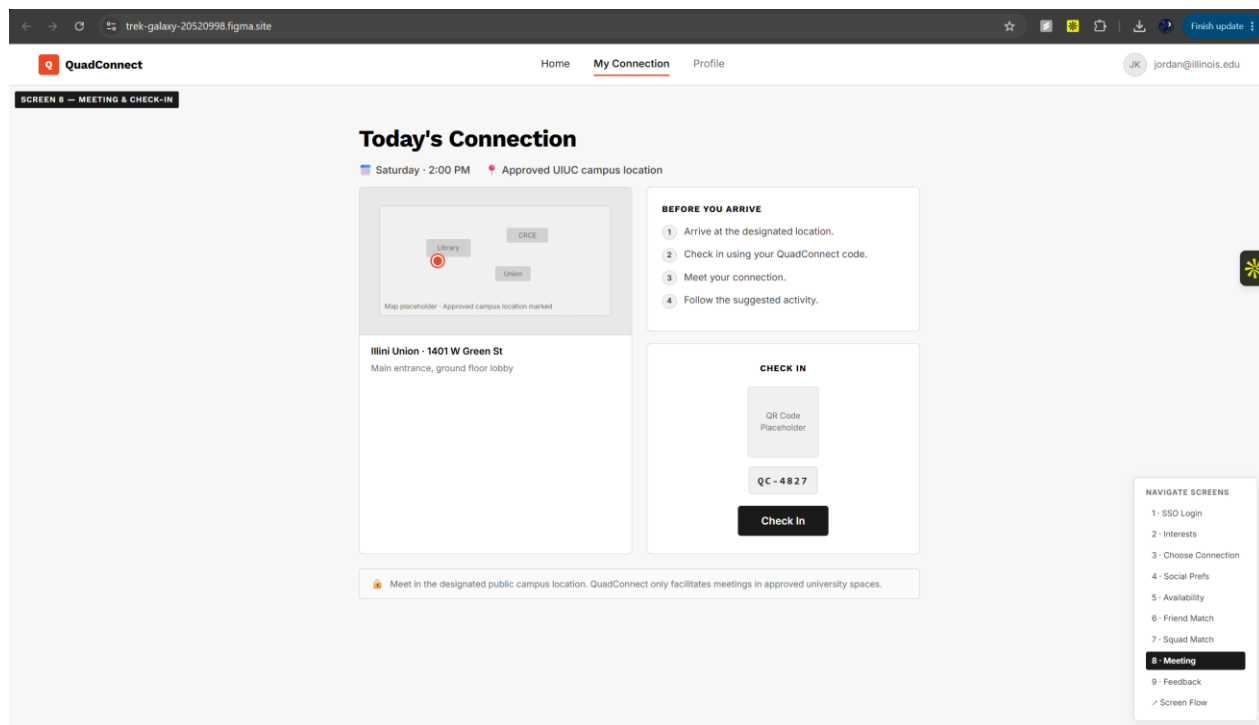
Screen 7 — Squad Connect Match

Purpose: Presents a small group of compatible UIUC students, highlights shared interests, and provides the group's suggested experience.



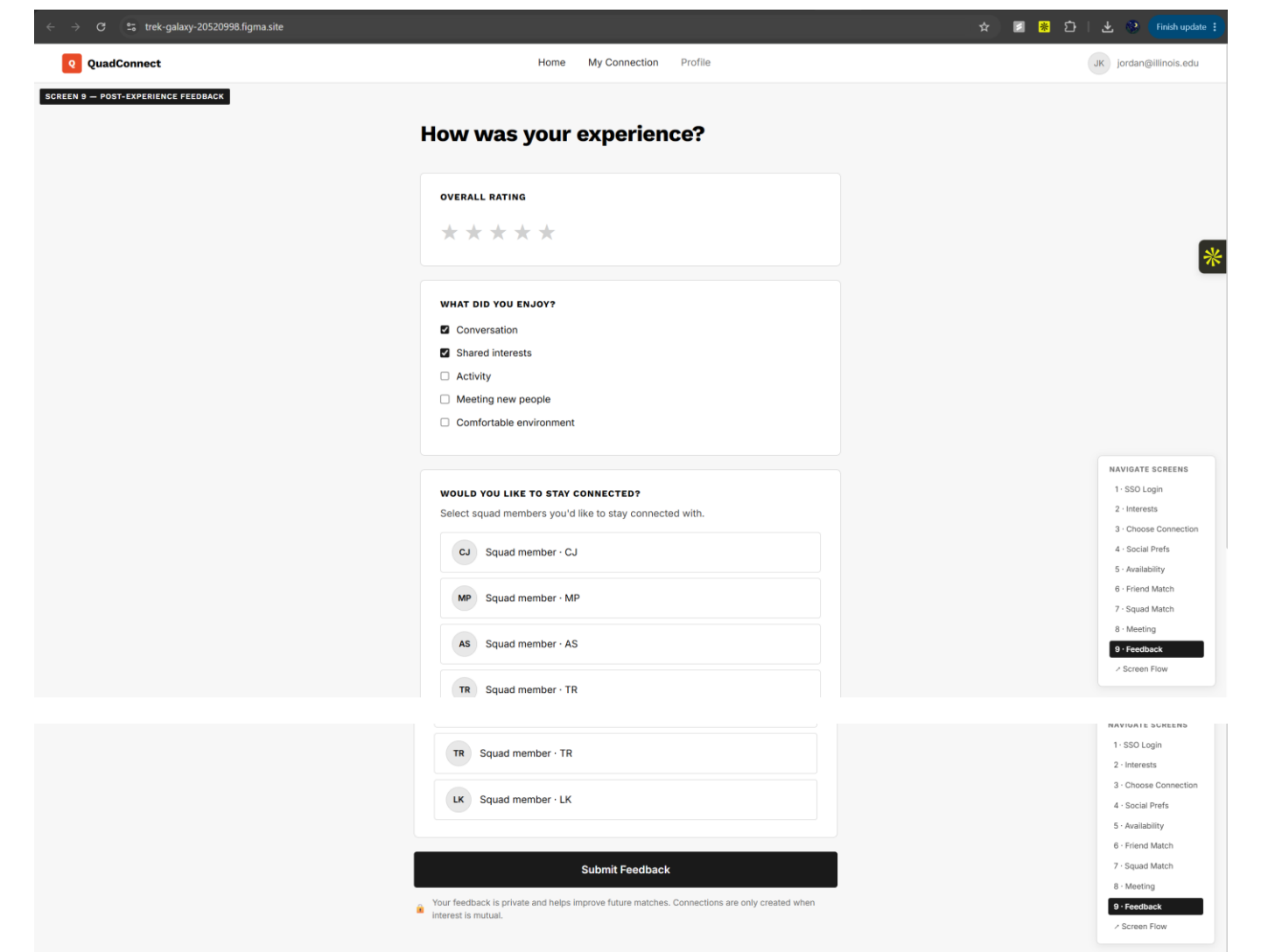
Screen 8 — Meeting & Check-in

Purpose: Provides the approved campus meeting location, arrival instructions, and a check-in mechanism before the experience begins.



Screen 9 — Post-Experience Feedback

Purpose: Collects private experience feedback and lets students indicate which participants they would like to stay connected with.



Screen Flow

This shows the overall screen flow

